



‘It is in India’s own interest to keep the data flows open’

Nick Clegg, President of Global Affairs at Meta, talks about the importance of artificial intelligence, regulation and more

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This is the age of artificial intelligence (AI). And one of the biggest questions the world is grappling with is how AI should be regulated. Then there’s social media, which humankind can’t seem to have enough of. And the behemoth that is straddling these worlds is Meta, with its bouquet of three popular social media services—WhatsApp, Instagram and Facebook. Shepherding the company through the complex process of global regulations and the pressing

issues of the day is Nick Clegg, President of Global Affairs at Meta. Clegg, who is also a former Deputy Prime Minister of the UK, in an interaction in Delhi with *Rahul Kanwal*, News Director of *India Today* and *Aaj Tak*, and Executive Director of *Business Today*, talks about AI, regulation, Meta’s latest product Threads and innovation, among other things. Edited excerpts:

Q: I want to start by talking to you about AI and the manner in which it is capturing global imagination. But who should regulate artificial intelligence?

A: AI is not new. It’s been around for decades. There’s a lot of hype at the moment around something called generative AI... But I think it somewhat obscures the reality that AI has been around for years. At Meta, for instance, we’ve been using AI for ages; anything you see on Facebook or Instagram has, in one way or another, been touched by AI already. I think how to regulate it is a question of first working out what harms and problems you’re trying to deal with. Is it intellec-